

BRAND GUIDELINES · MAKARIOS MARKETING

Duality *Salon*

A mother and daughter, two generations of one craft, and a room that is soft and industrial at once. This is how the brand looks, reads and photographs.

CLIENT

Duality Salon

LOCATION

Williamsville, NY

CONTACT

Sue Dicky

01	The Idea	Why the name is the strategy
02	Positioning	Sue and Leah, front and centre
03	Colour	Eight tokens, one accent
04	Typography	Cormorant Garamond and Jost
05	Layout	Bands, devices and components
06	Photography	The room does the work
07	Voice	Expert, warm, never salesy
08	The Team	Bios for the About page
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11	Components	Buttons, forms, navigation, motion
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The name is the *whole strategy*.

We do not need to invent this. The salon already says it, in their own words.

*Beautiful style is achieved through mastery of contrasting elements:
dark and light, wavy and straight, dynamic and still.*

DUALITY SALON

That line is the brand strategy, and it belongs somewhere prominent on the new site. Everything in this document is that idea applied. It is true of the salon three times over: Sue and Leah are mother and daughter, the room is soft and industrial at once, and the work is both technical precision and personal care.

Soft

Warm, personal, unhurried. The half that makes someone feel looked after.

Paper and mist grounds, a single blue accent

Cormorant Garamond, light and high contrast

Natural window light, skin tones, texture

Language about conversation and care

Industrial

Clean, precise, confident. The half that says these people know exactly what they are doing.

Ink grounds and hairline rules

Jost, geometric and even in colour

Straight edges, generous space, no clutter

Language about precision and craft

Use both on every surface. All soft goes generic salon. All industrial goes cold. The tension between them is the brand.

Sue and Leah, *front and centre*.

The client's own direction, and the right one. Most salon sites lead with a stock photo of hair. This one leads with two named people and a family story, which is the one thing competitors cannot copy.

Sue is Artistic Director, with four decades behind the chair and a background as a L'ANZA educator training stylists up and down the East Coast. Leah is the owner. She grew up in it and now leads the education side. That hand-off between generations is the story both the homepage and the About page should carry.

Three proof points the build already uses well, all worth protecting: **100+ years of combined experience** across five stylists, **established 2020** in Williamsville, and the promise that the salon **never overbooks**. That last one is the strongest thing on the page, because it is a specific operational commitment rather than an adjective.

LEAD WITH

Named stylists with real faces

The mother and daughter thread

Never overbooking, stated plainly

Education, and the L'ANZA roots

Long-standing client relationships

AVOID

Stock salon photography of any kind

Luxury filler such as pamper or indulge

Leading with price or promotions

Anonymous "our team of experts"

Exclamation marks anywhere

Their blue, their grey, *one cool ground*.

The palette is built out of the existing logo, not around it. Paper and mist carry the soft half and should cover most of any page. Ink and charcoal carry the industrial half and do the structural work. Blue is the only accent, and it is used sparingly.

Blue #0677BA and charcoal #37373A are lifted straight from the logo, unchanged. Everything else is built to sit with them: the greys are cooled to match, and the grounds are a soft blue-white rather than a warm cream. The logo sets the palette, so the mark never has to fight the page it sits on.



Blue

#0677BA

--blue

From the logo, unchanged. The one accent: buttons, rules, large type.

Blue Deep

#05639B

--blue-deep

Links and small accent type on light grounds.

Blue Light

#7FB3D5

--blue-lt

Accent on dark grounds only. Never on mist.

Charcoal

#37373A

--charcoal

The logo wordmark colour. All headings.

Ink

#232427

--ink

Body text, and the dark full-bleed grounds.



Grey

#65666A

--grey

Secondary text and labels. A half-step deeper than the logo grey so it stays readable at body size.

Mist

#E9EDF1

--mist

Panels and blocks that sit on the paper.

Paper

#F5F7F9

--paper

Page ground.

Line

#D6DCE2

--line

Hairlines and dividers. One weight.

MIST ON INK

13.2 : 1 · safe at any size

INK ON MIST

13.2 : 1 · the default reading pair

BLUE ON MIST

4.1 : 1 · large text and buttons only

BLUE DEEP ON MIST

5.5 : 1 · use for links and small type

One serif with warmth, one sans with *discipline*.

The pairing carries the duality without anyone having to explain it. Cormorant Garamond is elegant, high contrast and soft. Jost is geometric, even and clean. Headlines in one, everything functional in the other, and never the reverse.

DISPLAY · CORMORANT GARAMOND · 300 / 400 · ROMAN AND ITALIC

Colour, style and *self-care* in Williamsville

Headlines, stylist names, pull quotes. Cormorant is light and high contrast, so it needs size and air to work. Never below 20px, and the italic carries one emphasised word rather than a whole line.

INTERFACE · JOST · 200 TO 500

Book an appointment · Curly and textured hair · Hand-tied extensions · Balayage and dimensional colour ·
Wednesday to Saturday

Navigation, buttons, labels, body copy, forms, captions. Jost is even in colour, which is what keeps the pages feeling clean next to the serif. Uppercase labels take 0.28em tracking. Body copy never drops below 16px, and weight 300 is for large text only.

DISPLAY

Cormorant 300 · 58 / 0.9

SECTION

Cormorant 300 · 42 / 1.1

NAME

Cormorant 400 · 28 / 1.1

LEDE

Jost 300 · 19 / 1.8

BODY

Jost 400 · 16.5 / 1.75

LABEL

JOST 400 · 11 / UPPERCASE

The page alternates, *the way the brand does.*

The single most important structural rule in the build is the band rhythm. Mist section, then ink section, then mist again, the whole way down. That is not decoration. It is the soft and industrial pairing made structural, so the page performs the brand idea rather than describing it.



Two rules keep it working. Never place two ink bands next to each other, and give every band enough vertical padding that the alternation reads as deliberate rather than stripey. Dark bands carry the moments that need weight: pricing, the never-overbook promise, education, and the closing call to action.

Recurring devices

The blue seal

GRAPHIC DEVICE

The circular monogram works as a stamp on dark bands, set large and low in opacity behind content, or small and solid as a badge. Use it once per band at most. It is the only ornament the brand needs.

Italic emphasis

HEADLINE PATTERN

Every section headline italicises one phrase in Cormorant: *a thoughtful conversation, the Duality team, have to say*. One phrase per headline, never two, and never a whole line. It is what makes the headings feel written rather than assembled.

Eyebrow label

SECTION MARKER

A small-caps Jost label sits above every section heading, tracked wide in grey or blue. It gives the long page structure without adding rules everywhere.

The offset card

IMAGE TREATMENT

A mist card overlapping the edge of a photograph, as used on the mother and daughter block. It softens a hard photo edge and is the one place the layout breaks its own grid. Keep it rare, two or three times across a page.

The price ledger

PRICING PATTERN

Service name left, price right, hairline between rows. No boxes, no badges, no strikethroughs. Honest pricing presented plainly is the point, and it is reinforced by the line about the stylist confirming the final price at consultation.

The step row

PROCESS PATTERN

Four steps across, separated by hairlines rather than arrows or numbers in circles. Book, consultation, service, at-home care. Numbers stay small and in blue.

Full-bleed photo strip

GALLERY PATTERN

Four images edge to edge with no gaps, running the full width. It gives the page a breath between reading sections and shows the room without a formal gallery.

Spacing. Band padding scales with the viewport rather than sitting at a fixed value. One hairline weight is used across the whole site. Colour blocks are separated by gaps of 2px, not 20px. Where something needs to feel apart from what surrounds it, use whitespace rather than a border.

Real room, real people, *real light*.

The room does the brand's work already. Warm cream walls and woven drum pendants set against a blacked-out ceiling and exposed ductwork, with live plants softening every corner and warm wood underfoot. That is the soft-and-industrial idea, built. Shoot it as it is, and keep the ceiling in frame on wider shots, because it is the industrial half of the palette.

The team wears **all black** in every photo, which reads as deliberate and should stay that way. It keeps group shots clean and lets the warm room and the hair carry the colour.

Of everything supplied, the education-class photo is the most valuable. Every stylist's bio claims ongoing training, and that one image proves it rather than stating it.

DO

Shoot in the salon, in its own light

Portraits at eye level, relaxed, to camera

Hands working, tools in frame

Leave space for type to sit

Keep skin tones warm and true

DON'T

Heavy filters or cool blue grading

Stock imagery, even as placeholder

Tight crops with no breathing room

Busy backgrounds fighting the subject

Mixed portrait styles on one page

One rule for the team page: every portrait shot the same way, same distance, same background treatment. Mismatched portraits are the fastest way to make a good team look unserious.

Expert, warm, and never *salesy*.

The site already has the right instinct with lines like "every great style begins with a thoughtful conversation." Keep it. Write the way Sue or Leah would talk to someone in the chair: confident about the craft, genuinely interested in the person.

SOUNDS LIKE DUALITY

"Every great style begins with a thoughtful conversation."

"We never overbook. Ever."

"We'll tell you what will actually work with your hair."

"Curly hair is its own craft, and we've trained for it."

DOESN'T

"Indulge in the ultimate pampering experience."

"Transform your look today!"

"Book now and save 20%."

"Our team of beauty professionals."

Bios for the new *About* page.

Tightened from the copy the salon supplied, kept in their own facts and their own warmth. Sue and Leah lead, as requested. Each one closes on something personal, which is what makes a team page worth reading.

ARTISTIC DIRECTOR · MOTHER

Sue Dicky

40 years behind the chair

Sue has spent four decades behind the chair and most of that time teaching other people how to do it well. She travelled the East Coast as a L'ANZA educator, training and inspiring stylists along the way, and she still hosts classes here at the salon.

What she values most is the clients she has known for years. Outside the salon you will find her sewing a new project or volunteering with her church's children's program.

OWNER & STYLIST · DAUGHTER

Leah Blachanec

Behind the chair since
2013

Leah is the daughter of a lifelong stylist, so you could fairly say this is in her DNA. She grew up surrounded by the work and turned that into salon ownership, and she has spent six years building the team here.

She leads on continued education, which is how the whole salon keeps getting better. Away from work she is caring for her houseplants, tending a small summer garden, and baking.

STYLIST

Amanda Pohlman

Almost 20 years in the
industry

Amanda followed her dreams into hairstyling in her thirties and has been growing her craft ever since. She loves a polished blowout that shows off the colour and the cut underneath, and she has taken class after class to keep refining her technique alongside the rest of the team.

When she is not at the salon she is travelling with her husband or spending time with family.

STYLIST

Darcy Ragione

Nearly 30 years in the
industry

Darcy grew up watching her grandmother give perms, and that is what pulled her into hairstyling. She builds custom cuts and styles around each client rather than working from a template.

She is a regular in the classroom, sharing ideas with other stylists and bringing new techniques back to her clients, and she continues her education here at the salon. Outside work she is at the gym or with her pups.

STYLIST · CURLS & VIVIDS

Marianna Campione

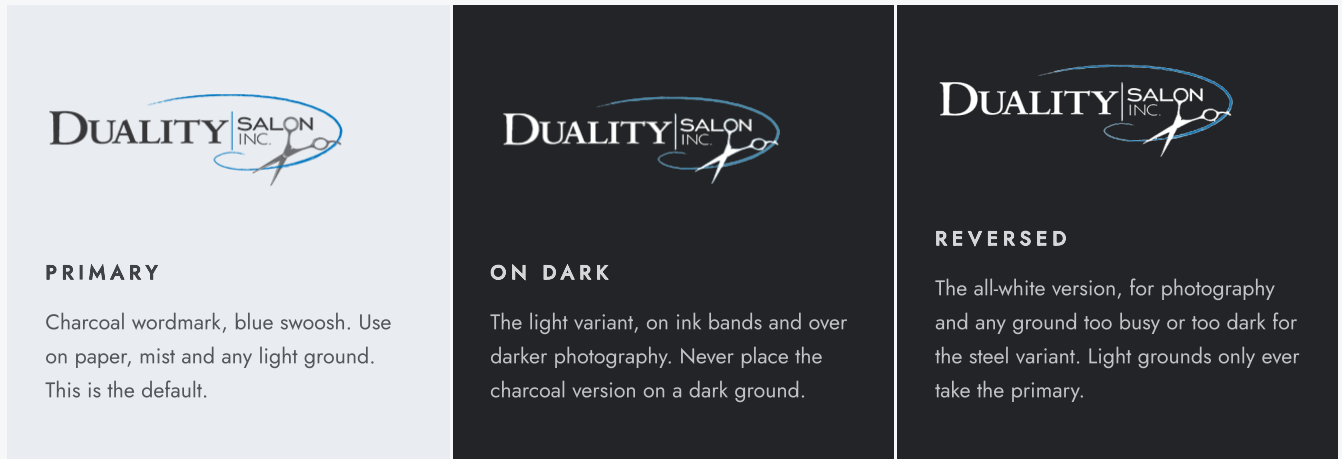
Creating hair magic since
2023

Marianna is a curly girl herself, which is exactly why clients trust her with their natural texture. She helps people stop fighting their curls and start feeling confident in them, and she loves the creative side of vivid colour.

She is deep into learning every hair type and texture there is, with more classes booked. Away from the salon she travels and gets lost in a good book.

The mark stays *exactly as it is*.

The logo is not being redrawn. Everything else in this document was built to sit with it, which means the mark never has to be adjusted to fit a page. Use it at full strength, give it room, and leave it alone.

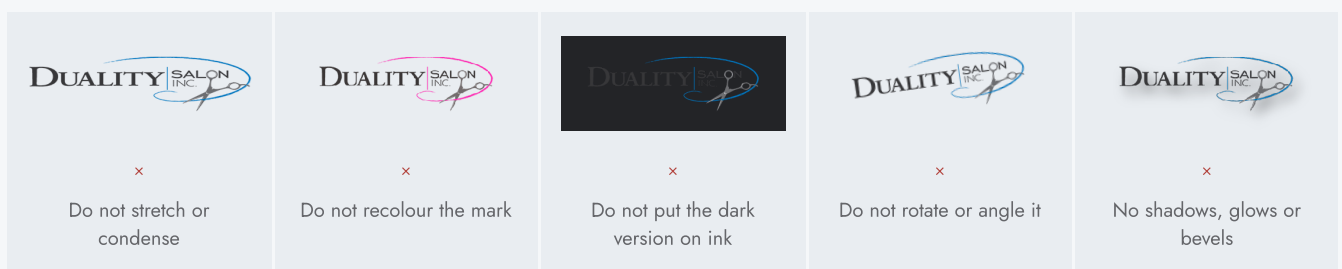


Clear space and size



Keep clear space on all four sides equal to the height of the *D* in Duality. Nothing enters that margin: no text, no rules, no photo edges, no other logos. Minimum size is **140px** wide on screen and **32mm** in print. Below that the SALON INC. line stops being legible and the scissors fill in.

What not to do



The grid is the *real shopfront*.

More people will meet Duality on Instagram than on the website, so the feed has to carry the same two halves as everything else. Warm, real work from the floor, held together by a disciplined frame.

PROFILE The light logo on ink, centred, with the swoosh fully inside the circle crop. Check it at 32px before saving.	GRID RHYTHM Alternate client work and room or team shots. Never three of the same kind in a row, the same rule as the page bands.	BEFORE AND AFTER Side by side, equal crop, same lighting, no arrows or collage borders. The work is the proof.
STORIES Blue for one accent element only. Keep type in Jost and leave the bottom fifth clear for stickers and replies.	CAPTIONS Written in brand voice, first person plural. Name the stylist who did the work. One question at most.	HANDLE Used consistently across every platform and matching the website footer exactly.

DO Shoot in the salon, in daylight where possible Credit the stylist by name in every work post Get client permission before posting their hair Keep the blue for one accent per frame	DON'T Stock imagery or reposted model shots Heavy filters that shift the true hair colour Text stacked over a client's face Countdown and sale graphics in other brands' colours
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The hair colour in a photograph is the product. Any filter that warms or cools it is misrepresenting the work, and it is the fastest way to create a disappointed client at the chair.

Booking is the *only job* the site has.

Every component below exists to move someone toward a booking without pressuring them. One primary action per screen, always visible, never repeated three times in the same band.

BUTTONS

Book an appointment

See services

Primary is solid ink with paper text and no radius. Secondary is a hairline outline in blue deep. On ink bands use the hairline outline with paper text. Labels are Jost, tracked, sentence case. One primary per band, never two side by side.

FORM FIELDS

Your name

Underline only, no boxes. Label sits above in Jost small caps. Errors appear beneath the line in words, not colour alone.

NAVIGATION

Logo left, links right, booking button held to the far right in ink. The bar turns solid on scroll rather than fading. Mobile collapses to a full-height panel, never a cramped dropdown.

CARDS

Mist ground, no border, no shadow. Separation comes from the ground colour, not from lifting the card off the page. Heading, two lines, one link.

MOTION

One speed, 250ms, ease-out. Links shift right on hover rather than changing size. Nothing animates on scroll beyond a simple fade. Honour reduced-motion settings.

ACCESSIBILITY

Tap targets 44px minimum. Visible focus ring in blue on every interactive element. Every image carries real alt text. Never use colour as the only signal.

One spelling, *everywhere*.

Search engines treat the salon's name, address and phone number as a fingerprint. When those details are written differently across the website, Google Business Profile and directory listings, the listings compete with each other and local ranking suffers. These are the exact forms to use.

NAME	Duality Salon Use the legal form, Duality Salon Inc., only where a legal entity is required. Never "Duality Hair Salon" or "Duality Salon Buffalo".
ADDRESS	1606 Hopkins Road, Williamsville, NY 14221 Road spelled out in full, never Rd. No suite number unless one is added.
PHONE	(716) 998-8528 This exact format on the site and in listings. Link as tel:+17169988528.
WEBSITE	dualitysalonbuffalo.com Shown without www or protocol in copy. Links resolve to the https version.
LOCATION WORDING	Williamsville, NY The town, not "Buffalo", in headings and metadata. Buffalo may appear in body copy as the wider area served.

Page titles and metadata

HOME	Duality Salon Hair Salon in Williamsville, NY
SERVICE PAGE	[Service] in Williamsville, NY Duality Salon
STYLIST PAGE	[Name], Stylist Duality Salon
DESCRIPTION	Around 155 characters, written in brand voice, naming the town and ending on the booking invitation.

Keep service names consistent between the price list, the booking system and the page headings. If the price list says "Balayage" and the site says "Balyage" or "Hair Painting", they read as three different services.

